

NEERAJ RAI



General Manager - R&D @ WAGO GmbH | Ex-TCS, SHURE AUDIO TECHNOLOGY PVT. LTD.

Global R&D & Engineering Leadership | Full Product Lifecycle Ownership | Quality & Regulatory Compliance | Agile, DevOps & Digital Innovation

Cell: +91-76749222099

Email: neerajkumarrai@hotmail.com

neeraj_rai@outlook.com

Location: Hyderabad, India

Product Lifecycle Management | Global Capability Center (GCC) Setup | Business & Budget Optimization | Product Development End to End | Product Innovation & IP Creation | Embedded System | Software Architecture & Engineering | Digital Transformation | Cross-Cultural Team Leadership | High-Performance Team Building | Operational Excellence

24+ years of global experience in **research & development, product lifecycle ownership, and multidisciplinary engineering** across the USA, UK, Germany, Denmark, Finland, and India. Proven success in building **world-class engineering organizations from the ground up**, scaling cross-functional teams, and aligning R&D roadmaps with strategic business goals. Adept at steering **end-to-end product lifecycles**, from prototyping to commercialization, while embedding compliance, innovation, and accelerated time-to-market.

VALUE PROPOSITION



Global R&D Leadership + Business Governance

- Adept at **spearheading end-to-end product lifecycle management**, from concept, prototyping, and validation to global manufacturing and commercialization.
- Demonstrated expertise in **establishing and scaling Global Capability Centers (GCCs)**, leading cross-functional and cross-cultural teams, and embedding **process governance, innovation frameworks, and IP creation** to strengthen organizational competitiveness.



Product Innovation & Technical Expertise

- Proven success in securing **SEZ/STPI approvals, navigating compliance landscapes, and delivering cost-efficient engineering solutions** with up to 85% cost arbitrage versus global benchmarks.
- Skilled in **hardware and software architecture, platform engineering, and digital transformation initiatives**, with technical purview across cutting-edge tools and technologies (Hardware, Embedded, Analog & Digital, Software: HTML5, AngularJS, GraphQL, Java, C++, Python, DevOps, iOS & Android).



People & Organizational Leadership

- Recognized for **building high-performing teams** across hardware, embedded systems, software, and mechanical engineering, while **fostering a culture of innovation, collaboration, and operational excellence**.
- Trusted partner to executive leadership, with a strong record of **aligning R&D roadmaps to global strategic priorities**, optimizing multimillion-dollar budgets, and delivering accelerated, high-ROI outcomes.

KEY SKILLS

Strategic & Global R&D Leadership

- Product Lifecycle Management
- Global Capability Center (GCC) Setup
- Business & Budget Optimization

Innovation & Technology Expertise

- Product Innovation & IP Creation
- Software Architecture & Engineering
- Digital Transformation

People & Organizational Leadership

- Cross-Cultural Team Leadership
- High-Performance Team Building
- Operational Excellence

Technical Purview:

- Management Tools:** Project Scheduler 7, Microsoft Project & EPMS (MPP and Enterprise Microsoft Management System), Agile PLM Product Life Cycle Management Tool from Oracle, JIRA Tool, Clarity Project Management Tool, Quality Control QC, Figma.
- Technologies:** HTML5, AngularJS, GraphQL, jQuery, JAVA & CSS, iOS & Android Applications, DevOps, C++, Python, C# and C.

PROFESSIONAL BACKGROUND

WAGO GmbH | Aug. 2024 – Present

General Manager - R&D



Strategic R&D Leadership

- Define and execute global R&D strategy, establishing labs, processes, and governance frameworks to align with global engineering goals.
- Partner with global leadership to shape architectural direction, ensuring long-term scalability & technology integration across platforms.
- Build a multidisciplinary R&D team spanning hardware, mechanical, embedded systems, and software, nurturing a people-first culture.

Product Innovation & Lifecycle Ownership

- Direct end-to-end product development from prototyping, testing, and validation to manufacturing handover.
- Steer patent creation and IP development, reinforcing competitive advantage and market leadership.
- Collaborate with global marketing, compliance, manufacturing, and customer experience teams to ensure product-market fit.

Operational & Organizational Excellence

- Manage multimillion-dollar budgets, resources, and timelines, ensuring high ROI (Return on Investment) and accelerated delivery.
- Nurture and initiate coordination with vendors/suppliers for critical component sourcing, optimizing quality and cost efficiency.
- Foster continuous improvement and technical excellence, embedding best practices across R&D functions.

Key Achievements

- Spearheaded establishment of a high-performing R&D team, scaling from **0 to 25 within a year**, with a roadmap to expand to **50+** by next year.
- Orchestrated efficient program execution, achieving project completion in **18 months** against a standard 3-year industry cycle.
- Demonstrated cost arbitrage by delivering high-quality outcomes at **~85%** lower cost in India compared to Germany, driving cost savings.
- Achieved the first India-origin patent within one year, reinforcing the innovation culture and strengthening IP portfolio.

Shure Audio Technology Pvt. Ltd., Telangana | Jun. 2019 – May 2024

SHURE

Director (Engineering)

Strategic Leadership & Governance

- Directed the Shure Software Center in India, serving as a Board member to define vision, mission, and long-term R&D strategy, ensuring alignment with global engineering and business priorities.
- Partnered with U.S. leadership to shape product roadmaps & drive process excellence, integrating innovation into product development.
- Guided executive decision-making through market intelligence, competitive analysis, and technology trend insights for R&D investments.

Engineering & Product Development

- Led the full lifecycle product development of embedded software solutions for Shure's premium audio platforms (desktop, browser, mobile) from design and prototyping through validation and global deployment.
- Steered cross-platform software architecture, ensuring scalability, reliability, and compliance with security and quality standards.

Financial, Vendor & Operational Management

- Managed multi-million-dollar R&D budgets, resources, and timelines, achieving high ROI and delivery efficiency.
- Ensured business continuity and resilience during COVID-19, maintaining uninterrupted R&D delivery and **100%** workforce retention.

Key Achievements

- Accelerated workforce expansion from **35 to 155**, and further to **213 employees**, building a high-performing talent ecosystem.
- Innovated wired/wireless microphone systems, conferencing solutions, networked audio devices, and meeting management platforms.

TCS (Accounts Handled: ODC @ Shure), Telangana | Apr. 2014 – Jun. 2019

tcs TATA CONSULTANCY SERVICES

Account & Delivery Manager

R&D Program Leadership & Governance

- Founded Shure Offshore Development Center (ODC) in India, serving as the single point of accountability for engineering delivery.
- Partnered with global stakeholders to translate requirements into R&D roadmaps and strengthen trust.
- Spearheaded delivery of projects worth **USD 4.5M**, ensuring adherence to timelines, budgets, and quality benchmarks.

Engineering & Product Development

- Led product development across mobile, web, and desktop platforms, introducing innovative features and automation capabilities.
- Oversaw the design, prototyping, testing, and validation of iOS and Android applications for system verification and automation, contributing to Shure's global product portfolio.
- Integrated DevOps, testing, and lifecycle governance frameworks into engineering programs, ensuring reliability and scalability.

Operational Excellence & Capability Building

- Built organizational capability by setting up structured engineering processes, quality controls, and program tracking mechanisms.
- Drove continuous improvement initiatives that reduced defects, optimized delivery cycles, and improved cost efficiency.
- Strengthened global stakeholder confidence by achieving on-time, high-quality delivery, reinforcing India's role as a strategic R&D partner.

EARLY CAREER

R&D Head (Global Expert Center) Metso Automation India Pvt. Ltd., Maharashtra	Mar. 2013 – Apr. 2014
Project Lead/ Manager Honeywell Technology Solution, Hyderabad	Aug. 2011 – Feb. 2013
Program Manager Secure Meters, R&D Center, Rajasthan	Mar. 2008 – Aug. 2011
Project Manager & Coordinator Robert Bosch India Limited, Karnataka	Sep. 2005 – Mar. 2008
Hardware Lead CMMI Level 5 Mahindra Satyam Ltd., Satyam Computers, Telangana	Jan. 2005 – Sept. 2005
Hardware Team Leader Secure Meters, R&D Center, Rajasthan	Feb. 2001 – Dec. 2004

KEY PROJECTS & INNOVATIONS

- **Innovation Group Setup | Shure:** Spearheaded the creation of an innovation-driven product development group, embedding cutting-edge practices into new product design and delivery.
- **Audio Domain Project | Shure:** Directed application development initiatives, including mobile apps for iOS and Android, enhancing customer engagement and integration with global platforms
- **Occupant Safety Project | BOSCH GmbH:** Managed BMW Airbag ECU design program, driving compliance with automotive safety standards.
- **Smart Metering Infrastructure | Secure:** Led end-to-end execution of the AMR & Advanced Smart Metering solution for the UK market.
- **Distribution Transformation | Secure:** Steered DT application technology exploration and product delivery into mass manufacturing.
- **Industrial & Residential Meter Development | Secure:** Oversaw the design and launch of a 3-phase/4-wire direct-connected static tri-vector meter, catering to diverse industrial and residential applications.

EDUCATION

- **ISB Global Advance Management Program | Indian School of Business (Kellogg Accredited) | 2023**
- **MBA in Management | Sikkim Manipal University | 2010**
- **BE in Electronics | SGSITS | 2001**

TRAININGS & CERTIFICATIONS: Agile Certified SAFe 4 Practitioner || Green Belt Six Sigma Certified || CMMI Training || AWS Cloud

GRANTED PATENT: Design for Fire Safety Product ([Link](#)) + More (Information to be shared)

DIVERSE GEOGRAPHIES WORKED ACROSS: USA, UK, Germany, Denmark, Finland, India